

PLSC 476: Empirical Legal Studies

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Legal Employment: Categories

ABA Employment Categories (see also [here](#)):

- Bar Passage Required (e.g., attorneys, clerks)
- J.D. Advantage (e.g., consultants, bank examiners, etc.)¹
- Professional (e.g., accountant, teacher, etc.)
- Non-professional
- Unemployed:
 - Full-Time Graduate Education
 - Start Date Deferred
 - Seeking Employment
 - Not Seeking Employment
- Unknown

¹ "...the employer sought an individual with a J.D. (and perhaps even required a J.D.), or for which the J.D. provided a demonstrable advantage in obtaining or performing the job, but the job itself does not require bar passage, an active law license, or involve practicing law."

Legal Employment: Types

ABA Employment Types:

	Part-Time	Full-Time
Short-Term	I	II
Long-Term	III	IV

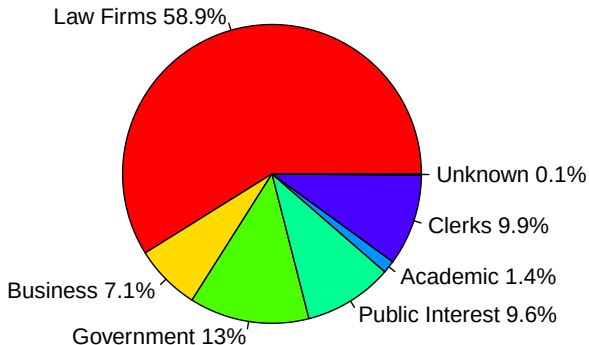
In general:

- Long-Term > Short-Term
- Full-Time > Part-Time, so
- $I < II \approx III < IV$

ABA Employer Types:

- Law Firms (of any size)
- Businesses (not including law firms)
- Government
- Public Interest Positions
- Academic (all levels)
- Judicial Clerks (all levels)
- Unknown

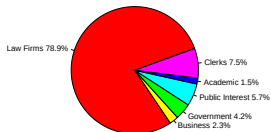
J.D. Employers, 2024 (All Schools)²



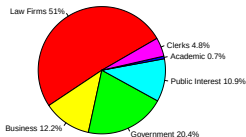
²Never, ever use pie charts.

J.D. Employers, 2024: Three B1G Schools³

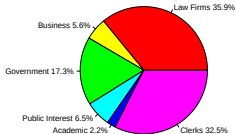
Northwestern Law



U. of Nebraska Law

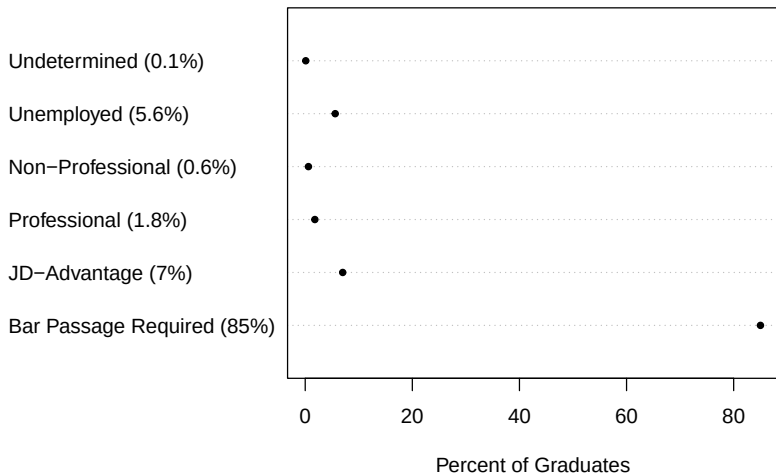


University of Maryland Law

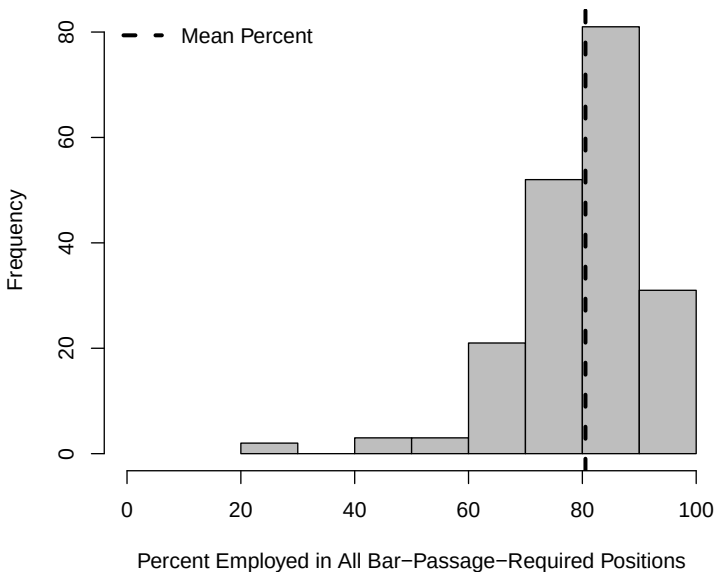


³Ever.

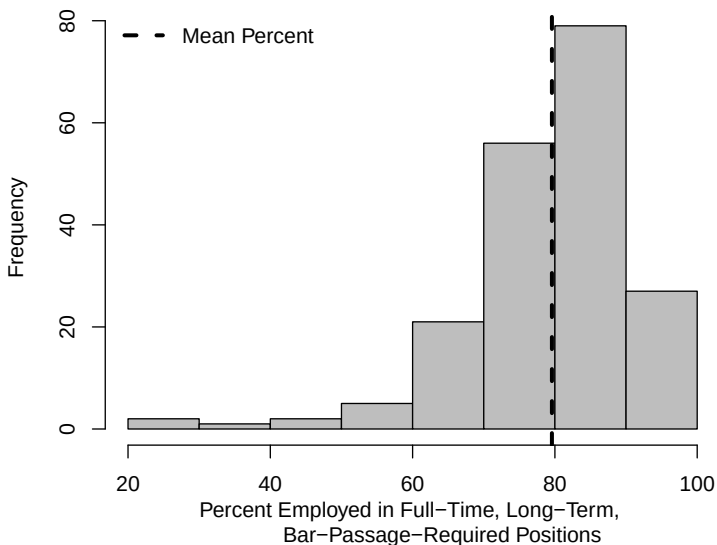
J.D. Employment, 2024 (All Schools)



Bar-Passage-Required Percentages (2024)



“BPR-FTLT” Percentages (2024)



Highest and Lowest “BPR-FTLT” Percentages

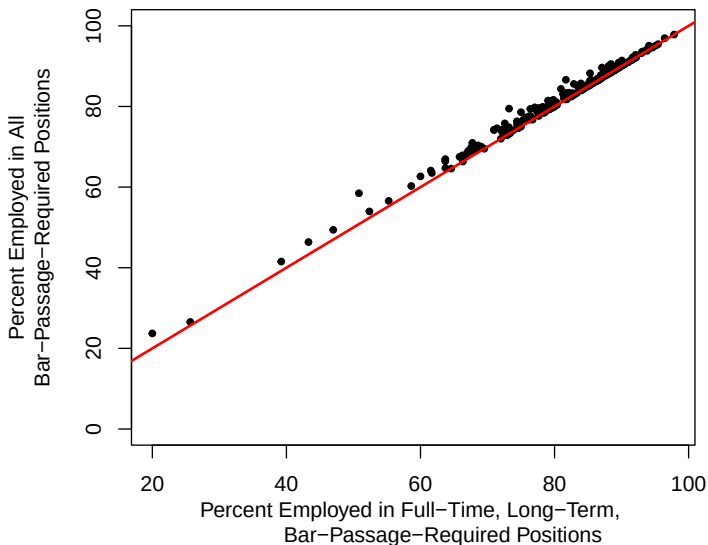
Top 10:

School Name	BPR-FTLT Percent
Duke University	97.83
Cornell University	96.43
Baylor University	95.45
Washington University	95.09
University of Virginia	94.65
Columbia University	94.26
University of Illinois	94.09
University of Chicago	93.97
Texas A&M University	93.82
University of Michigan	93.79

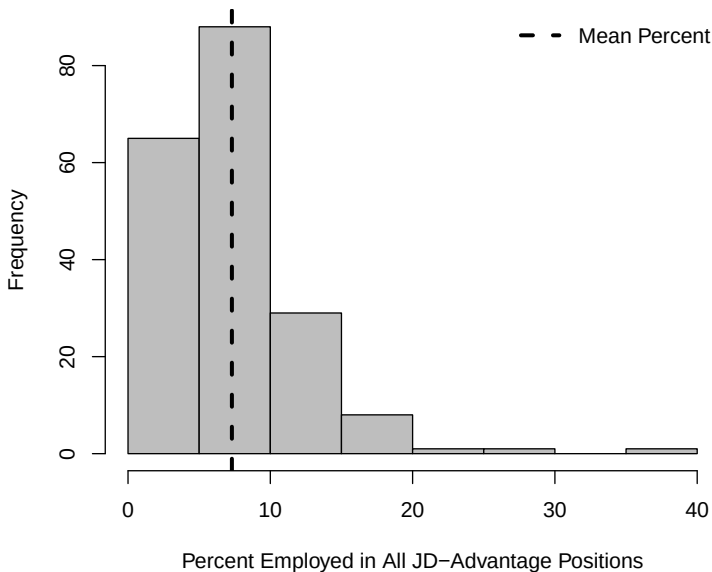
Bottom 10:

School Name	BPR-FTLT Percent
North Carolina Central University	60.00
New England Law Boston	58.63
Western State College of Law	55.26
District of Columbia	52.38
Texas Southern University	50.82
Atlanta's John Marshall Law School	46.99
Southern University	43.30
University of Puerto Rico	39.23
Pontifical Catholic University of P.R.	25.66
Inter American University of Puerto Rico	20.00

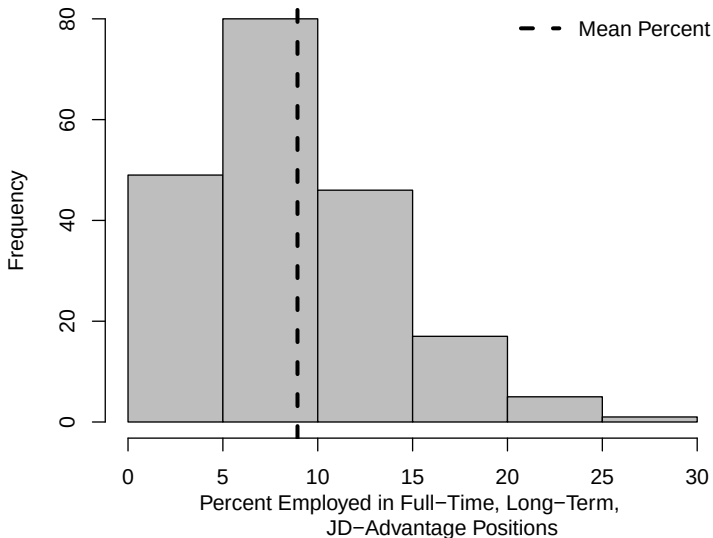
Bar-Passage-Required Comparison (2024)



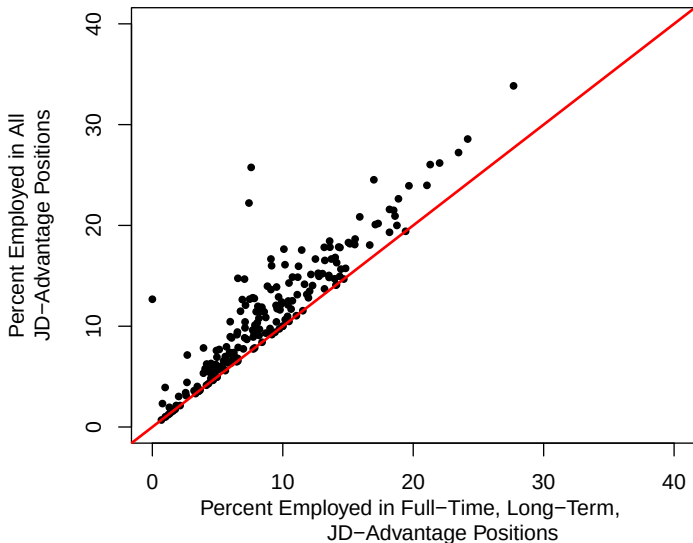
J.D.-Advantage Percentages (2024)



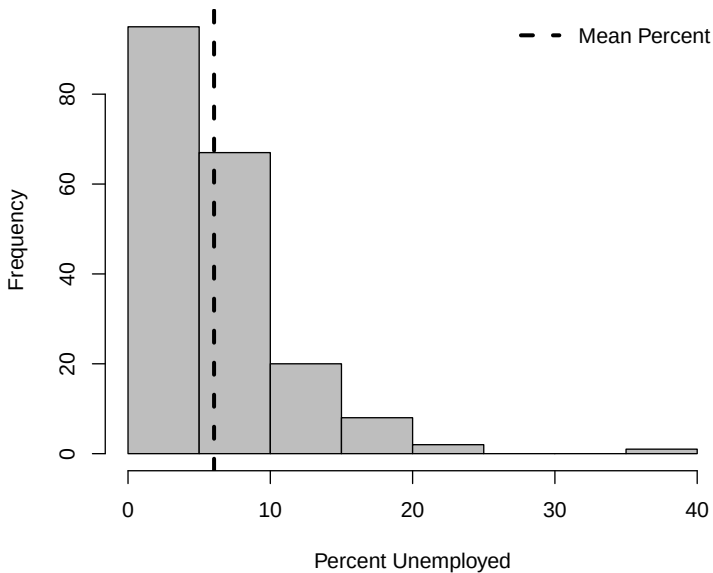
“JDA-FTLT” Percentages (2024)



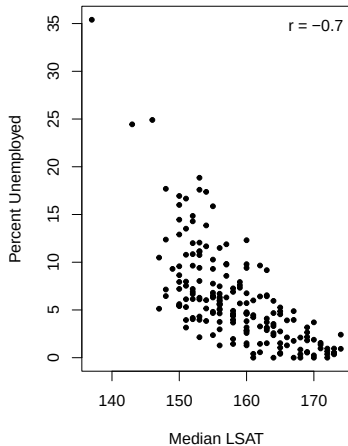
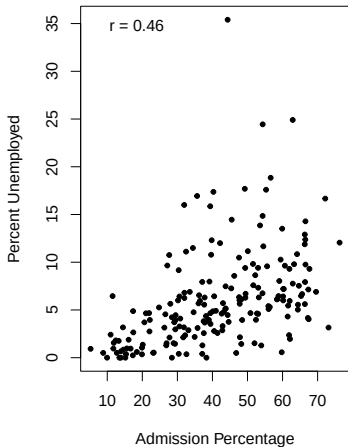
J.D.-Advantage Comparison (2024)



Unemployment Percentages (2024)



What Correlates With Unemployment?

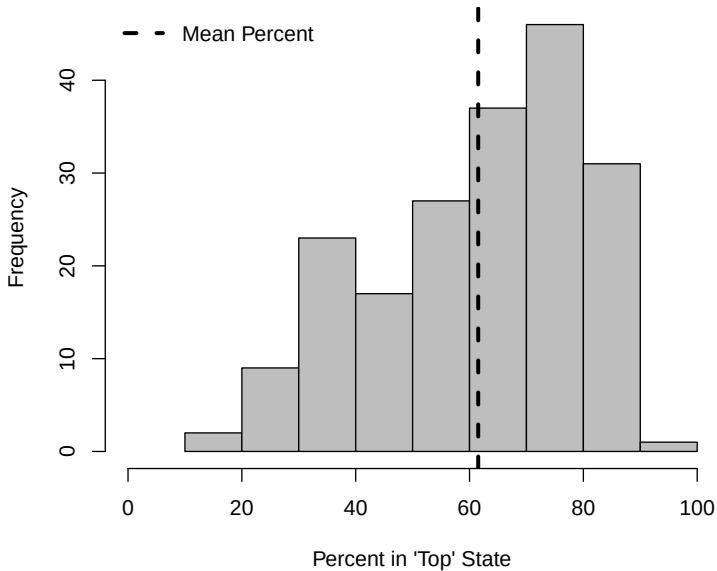


J.D. Employment: Location

Some facts:

- Most law graduates take the bar and seek employment in the state where they attended law school
- Schools vary widely in their geographic “reach” ...
- Reasons:
 - Reputation / Prestige
 - Specialization(s)
 - Unusual Contexts (e.g., state laws)
- ABA collects data on each law school’s “*top state*” – the number of its graduates who are employed in the state employing the largest number of that school’s graduates

“Top State” Percentages (2024)



Highest and Lowest “Top State” Percentages

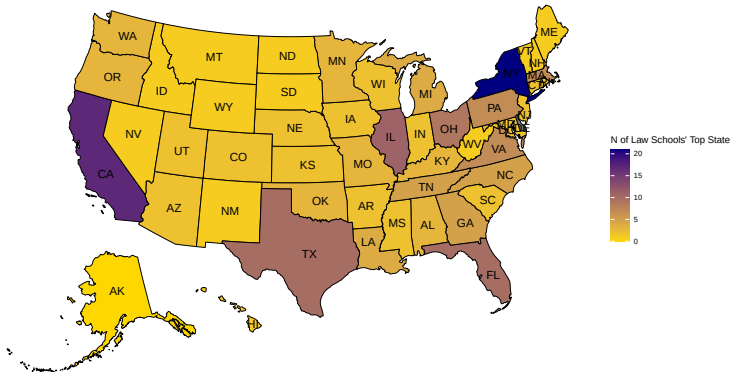
Top 10:

School Name	Top State Percent
Loyola Marymount University-Los Angeles	90.77
Southern Methodist University	89.88
South Texas College of Law	89.51
Western State College of Law	89.47
University of San Diego	88.76
University of Buffalo-SUNY	88.75
Wayne State University	88.41
Hofstra University	88.13
University of Houston	86.92
Baylor University	86.87

Bottom 10:

School Name	Top State Percent
University of Virginia	28.76
University of Mississippi	28.00
Washington and Lee University	24.82
University of Chicago	24.12
Liberty University	24.11
University of Michigan	23.29
Vanderbilt University	22.89
University of Notre Dame	21.93
Washington University	17.89
Vermont Law School	12.33

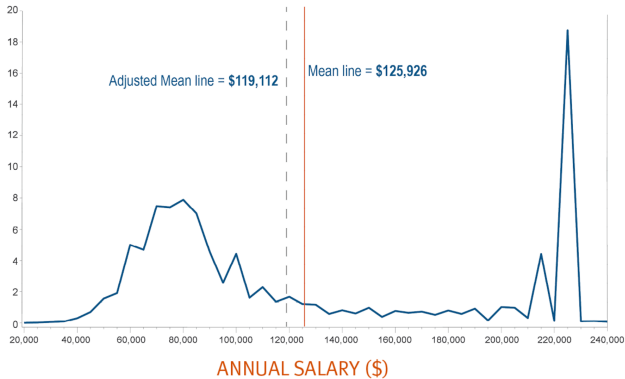
Map of “Top States” (2024)



Starting Salaries, Class of 2024 (via NALP)

Distribution of Reported Full-time Salaries – Class of 2024

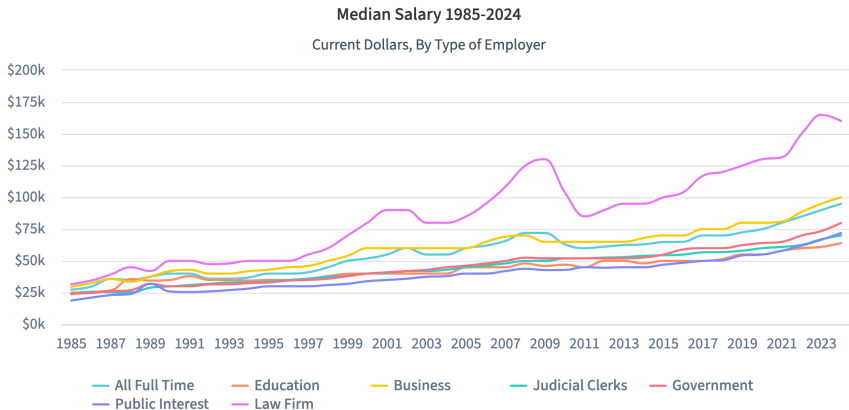
% OF REPORTED SALARIES



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www.nalp.org

(Source)

Median Salaries by Year and Type



(Source)